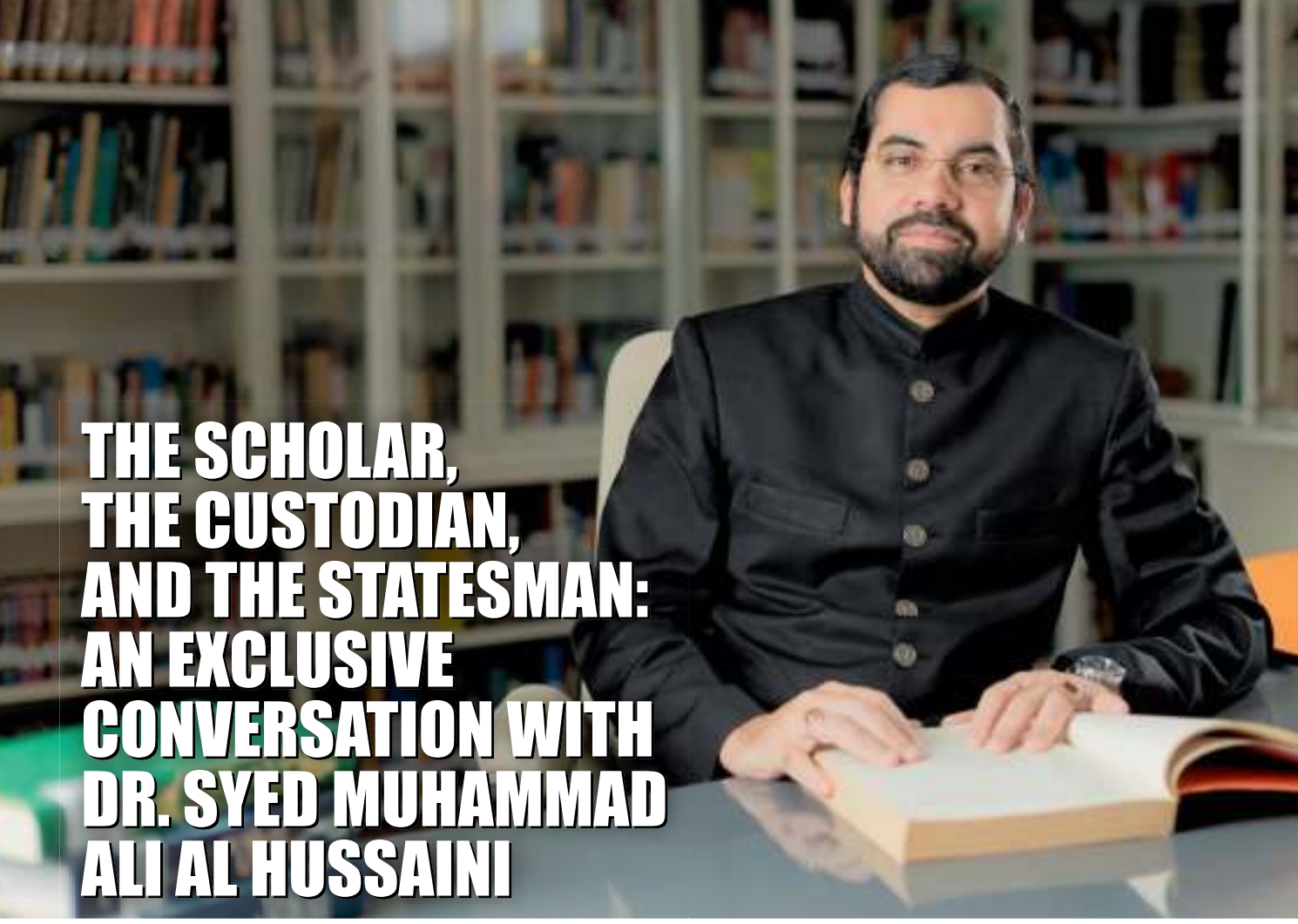


THE SCHOLAR, THE CUSTODIAN, AND THE STATESMAN: AN EXCLUSIVE CONVERSATION WITH DR. SYED MUHAMMAD ALI AL HUSSAINI

Located in the historical heart of Kalaburagi, Karnataka, Khaja Bandanawaz University (KBNU) stands as a premier multi-disciplinary institution of higher learning in the Kalyana Karnataka region. Guided by the enduring values of the 14th-century Sufi saint Hazrat Khwaja Banda Nawaz Gesudaraz, the university offers a vast array of professional programmes spanning medicine, engineering, law, sciences, and the humanities. Established in 2018 under the legendary Khaja Education Society (established in 1958), KBNU has rapidly evolved into an educational powerhouse.

At the helm of this transformation is the university's dynamic Chancellor, Dr. Syed Muhammad Ali Al Hussaini. An alumnus of Osmania and McGill Universities, Dr. Hussaini blends classical wisdom with global administrative insights. Crucially, his leadership extends far beyond the campus gates; he serves as the Sajjada Nasheen (spiritual head) of the revered Hazrath Khaja Bandanawaz Dargah and the Chairperson of the Karnataka State Board of Auqaf (State Waqf Board). In this comprehensive dialogue, he outlines his integrated vision for academic excellence, state-level administrative reforms, and the preservation of a timeless pluralistic legacy.

Dr. Hussaini, thank you for speaking with us. You inherit an illustrious legacy dedicated to social upliftment in Kalaburagi. Your grandfather, the Late Padmashree Janab Syed Shah Muhammad Muhammad Al Hussaini Saheb, founded the Khaja Education Society in 1958, and your father, His Holiness Dr. Syed Shah Khusro Hussaini, was KBNU's founding Chancellor. How does it feel to shoulder this monumental responsibility?

It is both an extraordinary honour and a profound duty. I grew up observing my grandfather and father dedicate their lives to nurturing the aspirations of this region. What began in 1958 as an initiative to provide primary schooling to underrepresented sections has expanded into a vast educational network.

In 2018, under my father's visionary leadership, the Khaja Bandanawaz University Act consolidated our premier higher education institutions into a unified private university. As Chancellor, my objective is to ensure continuity while driving forward-looking modernisation. While we remain firmly anchored in our founding values of inclusivity and compassion, we are investing heavily in digital infrastructure, cutting-edge research, and industry-aligned curricula to bridge classical learning with modern global demands.

I believe that a university must never operate in a silo. A modern campus should be a living ecosystem where the arts,





